attacks in India, including on the Houses of Parliament in Delhi in December 2001, and later on the Indian Air Force base at Pathankot in January 2016 and on a security convoy of the Central Reserve Police Force in Pulwama in February 2019.

The JeM had been placed on the American State Department's list of foreign Islamic Jihadi organizations in 2001, listed as a terrorist organization by the United Nations in October 2001, and was supposedly banned by the Government of Pakistan. However, it was common knowledge that Masood Azhar had continued to lead the JeM, sometimes under different names, under the protection of Pakistan. Whenever a terrorist attack had taken place for which JeM claimed responsibility, the Government of Pakistan used to take him under 'protective custody', a euphemism for his lying low until emotions had cooled on the other side of the India–Pakistan border.

After the Soviet withdrawal from Afghanistan in 1990, the West grew concerned about the possibility of Islamic radicalism. The advent of a Taliban regime in Afghanistan, that could offer a base for such elements, caused a heightening of concerns. On 15 October 1999, the United Nations Security Council (UNSC) adopted Resolution 1267 (1999), establishing a committee to impose a limited air embargo and assets freeze on the Taliban. Over time, after 9/11, the sanctions regime evolved and the measures targeted a widening group of individuals and entities. In June 2011, the Security Council decided that the list of individuals and entities associated with Al-Qaida would be handled by the 1267 Committee, also known as the Al-Qaida Sanctions Committee, and a separate committee was created to oversee sanctions against the Taliban. The 1267 Sanctions Committee comprises fifteen members of the Security Council. Its task is to designate individuals and entities who meet the listing criteria, to 'lift' the sanctions when warranted, as well as to exempt certain individuals or entities from the purview of